

Essentially, a design template is a preformatted presentation file that contains customised slide masters, backgrounds, and other design elements like colour schemes, bullets, font styles and sizes, text animations (if desired), pictures, and so on. You use a design template to give your presentations a sleek and professional look.

**TIP**

It is advisable to first create your slide master and design template before adding your content. This way you can avoid having any text or other objects that do not conform to the design restrictions of your template and masters.

## 5.2 Using The Slide Master

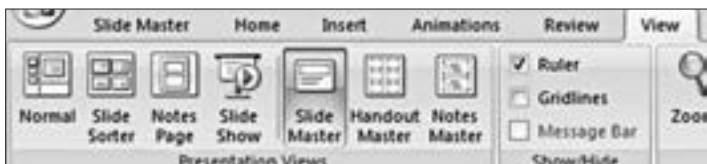
All presentations open in Normal view. To make changes to the master, open the slide master view. In PowerPoint 2003, go to View > Masters > Slide Master.

In PowerPoint 2007 click the View tab and select Slide Master from the Presentation Views section.

Using the slide master, you can define the default layout of the placeholders (the dotted boxes that contain text, graphics, and other objects), assign properties to text boxes that control the default font and font colour, specify details such as header and



PowerPoint 2003: Open the Slide Master to begin customising



PowerPoint 2007: Click the Slide Master button to begin customising